

## Get rid of the wires

Ways to make web watching more like TV-like, less PC-like  
<http://dthin.gs/vEuDsJ>



## "Hurt, lost or scared?"

The ₹2,494 5Star Responder, like OnStar, helps you in emergency situations  
<http://cnet.co/ufxBjI>

### Specifications

**SoC:** Qualcomm MSM8255-1 Snapdragon  
**Processor:** 1 GHz Scorpion;  
**Operating System:** Android 2.3.3; **Camera (front / rear):** 2 MP / 8 MP  
**Screen size:** 4.8 inches  
**Resolution:** 1024x480  
**Battery capacity:** 1500 mAh

### Contact

**Acer India Pvt Ltd**  
**Phone:** +91 80 3940 8700  
**Email:** [aileenquiries@acer.co.in](mailto:aileenquiries@acer.co.in)  
**Web site:** [www.acer.co.in](http://www.acer.co.in)  
**Price:** ₹28,990

7.0  
10

Features ..... 7.0  
 Performance ..... 6.5  
 Build Quality ..... 7.5  
 Value ..... 7.0

## Acer Iconia Smart S300

### A phone? A tablet? or a phone-let?

The screen size of 4.8 inches is about 0.5 inches longer than the largest screen seen on smartphones. Acer defined the product as "A smartphone with tablet like capabilities". So we'll address the S300 as a smartphone.

It runs on the Android Gingerbread (v2.3) operating system. Acer has added its own customisations to the Gingerbread OS called the Acer UI 4.2. The 1024x480 pixel screen has a backlit LED with Gorilla glass on top. The colours appear vivid and the viewing angles are also great. The reflective glass surface can be annoying at times, but daylight visibility is quite good. The 21:9 cinema aspect ratio makes it ideal for watching movies. Contrast is not that great.

Acer bundles a mini-HDMI to HDMI cable with which you can connect the smartphone to your HDTV.

We didn't face any issues with the call quality. The Iconia Smart houses a fine 8 MP camera. Image quality is good as long as you don't zoom in. Indoor shots are not that great without flash. You'll see minor artifacts if you don't use flash.

The Iconia Smart has a surprisingly low battery juice of just 1500mAh for a 4.8-inch screen device. It does last for a day with calling, surfing the net, listening to music and watching video content.

The Acer Iconia Smart S300 is a good device overall. But it does come with its kinks such as dif-



ficulty in one hand operation, apps not using the complete screen real estate, among other things. Acer needs to work on developing

dedicated apps which will utilise the full 4.8-inch screen real estate. The S300 has a single core processor and its pricing is in the range of dual-core smartphones. But then that depends on your use case scenario, as not many apps use the dual core completely. If you're a heavy media consumption junkie, Acer Iconia Smart S300 is a decent bet.

*Nimish Sawant*

## Lenovo IdeaPad K1 tablet

### Impressive performance, rough persona

Everyone is jumping on to the tablet bandwagon – and Lenovo is no exception. The K1 appears to be competing with Motorola Xoom.

It has a unique physical button for Home, something we haven't seen on Android 3.0 and beyond devices. This doubles up as a touch sensitive button, and will work as a back button when you use that gesture. The K1 back has a pattern on the plastic to aid grip, but the plastic quality used feels cheap. The camera is placed badly, and is easily smudged when holding it in landscape mode – similar to the Acer Iconia Tab A501.

All ports and slots are on the side panels, and the quality of buttons feel cheap. Not something

you expect when you spend well over ₹30k for a tablet.

We received the 32GB version, and what we love most is the memory slot to further expand storage space.

The tablet performed magnificently, delivering a smooth Android experience, with no slow-downs under app load. After a system update though, the tablet slowed to a crawl, but a couple of restarts later it was back to its blazing self.

The display is quite crisp and bright, and can get too bright if you don't activate the auto brightness setting. Viewing angles are decent, but not really as good as on the Galaxy Tab 750. The tablet heats up quite a bit after a mere



15 minutes of web browsing on Wi-Fi – terrible.

The battery life isn't the best, but we can't complain too much. We were concerned that the battery seems to fall pretty quickly even on standby, meaning you will find yourself charging it everyday unless you shut it down every night, or at least turn off Wi-Fi.

For a box price of ₹31,990 it's not the ultimate package. The Xoom is cheaper, and for just ₹1.5k more you can get the excellent Galaxy Tab 750.

*Visbal Mathur*

### Specifications

ARM Cortex A9 dual core 1GHz processor; 1GB RAM; 32 GB storage; 10.1-inch display; 5 MP camera (2 MP for video calls); Android 3.1; Wi-Fi + 3G

### Contact

**Lenovo India**  
**Phone:** 08030533000  
**Email:** [lenconsumer@in.ibm.com](mailto:lenconsumer@in.ibm.com)  
**Web site:** [www.acer.co.in](http://www.acer.co.in)  
**Price:** ₹28,990

6.0  
10

Features ..... 6.0  
 Performance ..... 7.5  
 Build Quality ..... 5.0  
 Value ..... 5.5